

FNB Clicks-to-Bricks: Transforming Banking Product Discovery

Senior UX Strategist Case Study

Overview

Traditional banking websites often force customers to navigate complex product structures, disconnected application experiences, and confusing terminology. As part of First National Bank's Clicks-to-Bricks strategy, the organization sought to reimagine how customers discover, compare, evaluate, and purchase financial products online. The initiative evolved into the foundation of FNB's eStore experience, a retail-inspired digital banking platform designed to improve product discovery, customer education, and conversion.

My Role

Senior UX Strategist responsible for customer research, usability testing, journey mapping, persona development, experience strategy, information architecture, wireframing, A/B testing strategy, stakeholder alignment, and product discovery design.

The Challenge

Financial institutions frequently organize products around internal business structures rather than customer goals. Customers struggled to identify the right products, compare options, understand features, and confidently complete applications. The challenge was not simply redesigning pages but rethinking how banking products are discovered and purchased through digital channels.

Business Objectives

- Increase product discoverability by helping customers quickly find products that align with their needs.
- Improve conversion by reducing friction throughout the evaluation and application process.
- Support omnichannel banking by creating a seamless connection between digital and branch experiences.
- Modernize the perception of banking through a retail-inspired shopping experience.

Research Approach

A comprehensive discovery effort was conducted using moderated customer interviews, field research, usability testing, and collaborative synthesis workshops. Research participants represented a variety of financial backgrounds, product needs, and banking behaviors. Findings were synthesized through affinity mapping exercises to uncover patterns in customer decision-making and product selection behaviors.

Key Research Findings

Customers consistently behaved more like retail shoppers than traditional banking customers. They wanted to compare options, understand differences between products, and build confidence before committing. Research also revealed significant variation in financial literacy levels, highlighting the need for both educational content and simplified decision support throughout the experience.

Customer Segmentation

Research identified several shopper archetypes including Browsers, Researchers, Product-Focused Shoppers, Bargain Hunters, and Emerging Customers. Each segment demonstrated unique behaviors, motivations, and information needs. These insights informed navigation, content strategy, product organization, and conversion pathways.

UX Strategy

The strategy centered on treating financial products like retail merchandise. Rather than forcing customers through traditional banking hierarchies, the experience emphasized product comparison, education, guided discovery, and multiple paths to conversion. The objective was to reduce cognitive load while supporting different customer shopping styles.

Experience Design

The solution introduced a new product discovery framework that organized financial products around customer goals and needs. Homepage concepts were explored through A/B testing, product detail pages were redesigned to improve scannability and comparison, and navigation structures were optimized to support product exploration. Educational content was integrated directly into decision-making moments rather than isolated in separate sections of the site.

Design Evolution

Low-fidelity concepts focused on information architecture and product organization. Medium-fidelity wireframes explored homepage layouts, product catalogs, account overview experiences, and comparison tools. Designs were refined iteratively through stakeholder feedback and usability validation to ensure alignment with customer expectations and business objectives.

Strategic Impact

The work helped establish foundational experience patterns that became central to FNB's eStore platform and broader Clicks-to-Bricks strategy. The resulting experience supported improved product discovery, stronger customer education, simplified account selection, and more seamless digital-to-branch transitions. The initiative demonstrated how UX strategy could influence enterprise-wide customer engagement and digital transformation efforts.

Reflection

This project reinforced the importance of understanding customer behavior before designing solutions. By approaching banking through the lens of retail shopping behaviors, the team created an experience that better aligned customer expectations with business goals. The initiative remains one of the strongest examples of strategic UX leadership, customer-centered innovation, and experience transformation in my portfolio.

Portfolio Summary

Challenge: Customers struggled to discover, compare, and confidently select financial products online.

Solution: Led UX strategy and research efforts to create a retail-inspired product discovery

experience that integrated customer education, persona-driven navigation, product comparison, and omnichannel engagement.

Impact: Helped establish foundational experience patterns that supported FNB's award-winning eStore platform and Clicks-to-Bricks digital transformation strategy.